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Module 1

Greetings and Introduction

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Look at these pictures. What are the people doing?



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Greetings and Introduction

- We use greetings and introductions in our first- time interactions with people.
- There are different ways to greet people and introduce yourself in English.
- We use different words and expressions to greet people in different situations.
- In this lesson, we are going to learn about different words and phrases to greet people or to make introductions in English, and we are also going to see the language you should use in formal and neutral/ informal situations.

Greetings and Introduction

- Just imagine that you are at a conference and you are going to introduce yourself to a fellow participant, or you are just about to introduce yourself before a panel at an interview.
- How would you introduce yourself?
- In these situations, you have to use more formal language.
- On the other hand, you are going to meet your new roommate from your hostel.
- How are you going to introduce yourself?
- In this situation, you have to use relatively more informal or neutral words and phrases to introduce yourself.



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Formal and Informal Words/Phrases

- Look at these two dialogues. Can you tell me which is formal and which one is relatively informal?

- **Dialogue 1**

- A: Good morning. You must be Tanya?
- B: Good morning. I'm sorry, and your name is....?
- A: My name's Tarun. Very nice to meet you.
- B: Nice to meet you too.
- A: How are you today?



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Formal and Informal Words/Phrases

- B: Very well. Thank you and yourself?
- A: I'm good. Thanks for asking.
- **Dialogue 2**
- A: Hello!
- B: Hello!
- A: Are you Tanya?



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Formal and Informal Words/Phrases

- B: Yes, that's right.
- A: What's your name?
- B: Tarun
- A: Nice to meet you
- B: And you
- A: How are you?
- B: Pretty good, thanks and you?
- A: Likewise, thanks.



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Formal and Informal Words/Phrases

- **Dialogue 1** starts with good morning.
- The greetings **good morning**, **good afternoon** and **good evening** are quite formal and are generally only used in formal situations.
- There's one exception, you can use **good morning** informally with people you know.
- However, it is more common in this situation to simply say '**morning**'.
- On the other hand, I start the second dialogue by saying '**hello**'.
- The greeting '**hello**' is neutral, that is, neither formal nor informal. You can use hello in any situation.
- Other greetings like '**hi**', '**hey**' are only used in informal situations.

Formal and Informal Words/Phrases

- Secondly, I asked B's name by saying **you must be Tanya?**
- B asked A's name by saying, and **your name is?** These are more formal than **“What's your name?”**
- After she introduced herself, she said **very nice to meet you.**
- Saying **nice to meet you** is neutral. However, adding very makes it sound much more formal. One word makes a big difference.
- I introduced myself with a full sentence: **My name's Tasha.**
- When speaking less formally, you would use shorter sentences, like **I'm Tasha** or simply **Tasha.**

Formal and Informal Words/Phrases

- After that, Tasha asked “**How are you today?**”
- Again one word makes the difference- do you know which word?
- It's **today**. Asking **how are you?** is neutral. Adding **today** makes it sound more formal.
- My response, **very well, thank you**, too is quite formal.
- If I was speaking more informally or neutrally, I would say something like, “**Pretty good, thanks**”

Formal and Informal Words/Phrases

- Finally Tanya asked me back how are you. Do you remember how she asked? She said, **and yourself?**
- This is more formal than saying **and you?**
- I replied by saying, **thanks for asking.** You wouldn't say thanks for asking in an informal situation.
- Now you know how small tweaks can make such big difference to how formal your language sounds.
- Other things like, **tone of your voice** and **body language** are also equally important.

More Examples

- DIALOGUE 1 (FORMAL)
- *(Gita Naidu and Madhu Kumar meet at the post office. They stay in the same colony, but do not know each other very well. It's three o'clock in the afternoon.)*
- *Madhu:* **Good afternoon**, Mrs Naidu.
- *Gita:* **Good afternoon**, Mr Kumar. **How**
- **are you?**
- *Madhu :* **I'm very well, thank you. And**
how're you, Mrs Naidu?



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More Examples

- *Gita*: **I'm fine, thanks.** I came to buy some stamps and inland letters.
- *Madhu* : I must send this card to my friend. It's her birthday next week, **Have a nice day**, Mrs Naidu.
- *Gita*: **Thanks**, and **you too. Bye!**
- *Madhu* : **Goodbye!**



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Useful points to remember

1. Specific

- The two persons in the dialogue you listened to are neighbours, but they *do* not know each other very well.
- So,
- (a) they address each other by their titles, not by their first names: *Mrs Naidu*, not *Gita*,
- and never *Mrs Gita*, and,
- (b) they say *Good afternoon* to greet each other, not *Hello* or *Hi*.



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Useful points to remember

2. General

- When we talk, we usually say I'm. . . It's. . . How're instead of I am ..., It is ..., How are
- We usually say Good morning up to twelve o'clock midday, Good afternoon between midday and five o'clock in the evening, and Good evening after five.
- We never say Good night to greet a person.
- Make sure to say Bye or Goodbye like the speakers you in the dialogue in the previous slide, with the voice moving from low to high.

More Examples

- DIALOGUE 2 (Informal)

(Lakshman and Srinivas are good friends. They meet outside a. restaurant after a month.)

- Srinivas: **Hello**, Lakshman!
- Lakshman : **Hi**, Seenu! **I haven't seen you for a long time. Where were you?**
- Srinivas: I was busy in school practising for Sports Day. I was in the races.
- Lakshman : How wonderful! You must've won many prizes.
- Srinivas: Not many. Only three.



More Examples

- *Lakshman* : That's great, Seenu. Congratulations!
- *Srinivas*: Thanks. **And what have you been doing? Come, Let's** have some coffee. **We haven't met in a long time.**
- *Lakshman*: **Wish I could have stayed, but** I'm really late for college. Let's meet on Sunday.
- *Srinivas*: We'll do that. **Bye, bye!**
- *Lakshman*: **See you!**



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Useful points to remember

1. Specific

- Lakshman and Srinivas know each other very well. So:
- Srinivas addresses Lakshman by his first name.
- Sometimes we call our friends by their pet names, just as Lakshman addresses Srinivas by his pet name *Seenu*.
- They say *Hello* and *Hi* to greet each other, not Good morning or Good afternoon.
- They say *Thanks* instead of *Thank you*.

Useful points to remember

2. General

- When speaking, we say:
- *haven't* for *have not*
- *that's* for *that is*
- *we're* for *we are*



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Introducing Yourself

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- This lesson will help you learn how to say who you are after greeting someone who does not know you.
- You will also learn how to respond to introductions.
- There are different ways of doing this depending on whether the situation is a formal or an informal one.

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Introducing yourself to someone

- DIALOGUE 1 (FORMAL)
- *(Prakash Reddy is a new teacher. He introduces himself to the headmistress, Nina Shetty. Time: morning)*
- *Prakash Reddy: **Good morning**, Mrs Shetty. **I'm** Prakash Reddy. **I'm** the new history teacher reporting for duty.*
- *Mrs Nina Shetty : **Good morning**, Prakash. **(I'm)** pleased to meet you. Welcome to the National School. **We're** glad to have you.*
- *Prakash Reddy :**Thank you. I'm** looking forward to working here.*

Introducing yourself to someone

- DIALOGUE 2 (INFORMAL)
- *(John is at a party. He introduces himself to Ahmed, his brother's friend.)*
- *John* : Hello. **I'm John. I'm Joseph's brother.**
- *Ahmed*: Hello, John! **Nice to meet you.**
- *John* : **Nice meeting you too.**

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Two strangers introducing themselves to each other

- DIALOGUE 3 (FORMAL)
- *(Two scientists meet at a seminar. Time: afternoon)*
- *Dr Swamy* : **Good afternoon!** I'm Narayana Swamy from REC, Warangal.
- *Dr Rao* : **Pleased to meet you**, Dr Swamy. I'm Srinivas Rao **from** Nehru Technical University.
- *Dr Swamy*: **I'm so glad to meet you.** Will you be presenting a paper today?
- *Dr Rao*: Yes, it's a report on my latest project.
- *Dr Swamy* **That's interesting.** I'm looking forward to your paper.
- *Dr Rao* : Thank you.

Introducing People to Others

- In this unit, you will practice how to use English to introduce two persons who are strangers to each other.
- Again, the language you will use to do this will differ depending on whether the situation is a formal or an informal one.



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Introducing People to Others

DIALOGUE 1 (FORMAL)

(Mrs Nina Shetty introduces Mr Prakash Reddy to Mr Akash Yadav, the English teacher.)

Mrs Shetty: Akash, **I'd like to introduce** Mr Prakash Reddy to you. He's the new history teacher

Akash Yadav: **Hello**, Prakash. **Glad to meet you**. I'm Akash Yadav. I teach English.

Prakash Reddy: **Nice to meet you too**.



Introducing People to Others

- DIALOGUE 2 (INFORMAL)
- *(Vijay, who is with his sister Kamala, meets his colleague Sagar at the railway station. He introduces the two.)*
- Vijay: **Hi**, Sagar. Going home to Guntur, are you?
- Sagar: **Hi**. Yes, I'm taking the Chennai Express.
- Vijay : Sagar, **meet** my sister Kamala. Kamala, **this is** my colleague Sagar. He's just become the head of our accounts department.

- *Kamala*: **That's nice. Pleased to meet you, Sagar.**
- *Sagar* : **Nice to meet you too.**



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Introducing People to Others

- DIALOGUE 3 (FORMAL)
- (*Dr Rekha Gupta and Mr Sriram Kumar are guests at the annual day function of a college. They do not know each other, but both of them know the principal, Dr Kiran Murthy. Dr Murthy introduces Dr Gupta to Mr Kumar.*)
- *Dr Murthy:* (to Mr Kumar) **Mr Kumar, meet Dr Rekha Gupta.** She's the new member on our Board of Governors. (to Dr Gupta) **Dr Gupta, (this is) Mr Sriram Kumar, the secretary.**
- *Mr Kumar:* **Good morning, (Dr Gupta). I'm pleased to meet you.**
- *Dr Gupta:* **Good morning. I'm pleased to meet you too.**

- *Mr Kumar* : We're glad you agreed to be on the board.
- *Dr Gupta* : It was kind of you to ask me.



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Introducing People to Others

- DIALOGUE 4 (FORMAL)
- *(Mrs Nina Shetty, the principal of a school, introduces Mr Prakash Reddy and Mr Akash Yadav to each other.)*
- *Nina Shetty:* (to Prakash Reddy) Prakash, **here's** Mr Akash Yadav. **He** teaches English. (to Akash Yadav) Akash, **I'd like to introduce** Mr Prakash Reddy to you. **He's** the new history teacher.
- *Akash Yadav:* **Hello**, Prakash. **Glad to meet you.**
- *Prakash Reddy:* **Nice to meet you too.**

Introducing People to Others

- DIALOGUE 5 (FORMAL)
- *(Shashi introduces her professor Dr Prakasam to her friend, Amit Dutta, who has been admitted to the first year BA class.)*
- *Shashi:* Amit, **I'd like you to meet** my professor, Dr Prakasam. Sir, **this is** my friend, Amit Dutta. **He's** taken the BA English course.
- *Dr Prakasham:* **Pleased to meet you,** Amit.

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- *Amit:* **I heard so much about you, sir. I was eager to meet you.**
- *Dr Prakasham:* **Thank you. That's kind of you.** I hope you enjoy your studies here.
- *Amit:* **I'm looking forward to** attending your classes, sir.
- *Dr Prakasham:* **I'll see you** tomorrow in class then.
- *Amit:* Yes, sir. I'll be there.

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Introducing People to Others

- DIALOGUE 6 (INFORMAL)
- *(Sheila and Praveen are classmates. They meet at an exhibition. Praveen is with his cousin, Ranjit, whom Sheila has never met. Praveen introduces Sheila and Ranjit to each other.)*
- *Praveen:* **Hello**, Sheila! Ranji, **this is** Sheila. **She's** in my class. Sheila, **meet my cousin**, Ranjit.
- *Sheila :* **Hi**, Ranjit. **Nice meeting you!**
- *Ranjit:* **Hi! Nice meeting you too**, Sheila! **You can call me** Ranji. Praveen has been talking about you.
- *Sheila:* Hope he's been saying nice things about me. **D'you** like the
- exhibition?

- *Ranjit:* Yes, very much. We're yet to get to the food stalls.
- *Sheila:* Go along then. The dosas are great.
- *Praveen:* We'll go and try them. Bye then!
- *Sheila:* (to Praveen) Bye! See you tomorrow. (to Ranjit) Bye, Ranji. See you!



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Giving Personal Information

- Sometimes when you introduce yourselves, you also need to give some personal information, such as your age, where you stay or belong to, your family and educational background and what you are doing.
- In this lesson, you will learn how to do this in both formal and informal situations.



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Giving Personal Information

- SELF-INTRODUCTION 1 (FORMAL)
- *(It is the first day of college for the first year BSc students. Each student has been asked to introduce herself | himself to the teacher and the class, and to give personal information. Listen carefully to what Surya Kumar says. Time: 11 a.m.)*
- **Good morning** to all of you.
- **I'm** Surya Kumar. **I'm** eighteen. **I come from** a small village in Kurnool district. Most of the people in the village are farmers. **My father** is also a farmer. **My mother** looks after the home. I have two elder sisters and one elder brother.

Giving Personal Information

- **I'm** the youngest in the family. **My sisters are** both married. One lives in Hyderabad and the other in Bangalore. **My brother is** doing his engineering. **I went** to a government school in Kurnool and passed the Intermediate examination with a first class. **I would like** to do my MBA after graduation. **I love** playing kho kho and football. **I'm fond of** music, mainly film songs. **I like** drawing too. **I'm looking forward to** making many friends here.

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Giving Personal Information

- To introduce himself and give some bits of personal information, Surya Kumar does the following.
 1. Begins by greeting everyone
 2. Then he tells them-
 - His name and age
 - About his hometown
 - About his family
 - About his schooling



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Giving Personal Information

- What he would like to do
 - What his hobbies/ interests are
3. Ends by saying how it feels to be in the college.



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Some Other Expressions

- Good morning everyone.
- My name is...
- I'm... years old.
- My home town is...
- I studied in ...
- I plan to ...
- My hobbies are... / I'm fond of ... /
- I'm interested in ...
- I'm delighted to be ... / I'm happy to be...



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Giving Personal Information

- SELF-INTRODUCTION 2 (INFORMAL)
- *(Saira Begum talks to her new classmates during the lunch break and tells them about herself.)*
- **Hi! I'm Saira. I'm seventeen. I'm from Hyderabad. I live near** the Charminar.
- **My father's** a cloth merchant. **He has** a shop near Madina Hotel. **He sells** readymade garments. If you're interested in buying clothes, I can take you to my father's store. **My mother teaches** in a nursery school.

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Giving Personal Information

- **She's a** wonderful cook. You can come home anytime because she loves to cook for our friends. **My brother's** in high school. **He's** very naughty, but we're good friends. **Both of us love** to watch movies on TV. **What else can I say about myself?** Oh, yes. **I'm fond of** painting. So, if any of you is interested, I can paint a picture of you. **I'm so glad** to be here. **I'm sure** we'll have a great time together.



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Answering the Telephone Asking for Someone

- The telephone is very much a part of our lives today.
- In this lesson you will learn to use English to make a telephone call, answer the telephone, greet the person at the other end of the line, ask for someone and respond when someone else makes such a request.
- You will also see how the language of formal telephone calls is a little different from that of informal calls.

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Answering the Telephone Asking for Someone

- DIALOGUE 1 (FORMAL)
- (*The phone rings in the office of EduBooks Publishing Company.*)
- *Receptionist:* **Good afternoon. EduBooks Publishing Company.**
- *Caller :* **Could I speak to the sales manager, please?**
- *Receptionist :* **Could I tell him who's calling, please?**
- *Caller:* **My name's Nitya Menon. I am calling from the Women's College library.**
- *Receptionist:* **Thank you, ma'am. I'll put you through to Mr Abdullah the sales manager.**
- *Caller:* **Thank you.**

Answering the Telephone Asking for Someone

- DIALOGUE 2(FORMAL)
- (*The phone rings in Suman's home.*)
- **Suman : Hello. Suman Bhushan.**
- **Caller : Hello. Could I speak to Mr Prem Bhushan, please?**
- **Suman: May I know who's calling?**
- **Caller: I'm Srinath, his colleague.**
- **Suman: Hold the line, please. Mr Bhushan will talk to you in a moment.**
- **Caller: Thank you.**

Answering the Telephone Asking for Someone

- DIALOGUE 3 (FORMAL)
- (*The phone rings in Ms Samuel's home. Santosh takes the call.*)
- **Santosh: Hello, this is 27613625.**
- **Caller : Is that Ms Karuna Samuel's residence?**
- **Santosh : Yes. Would you like to speak to her?**
- **Caller: Yes, please.**
- **Santosh: Could you hold on a minute, please? I'll call her.**
- **Caller : Thanks.**

Answering the Telephone Asking for Someone

- DIALOGUE 4 (INFORMAL)
- *(The phone rings in Sitara's home.)*
- Sitara: **Hello.**
- Caller: **Hi, Sitara. This is** Arun.
- Sitara: **Hi, Arun. What's up?** (informal way of saying, What's happening?)
- Caller : **Nothing much.** Remember, we have a meeting tomorrow morning.



Answering the Telephone Asking for Someone

- *Sitara* : Thanks for reminding me, Arun. It's about the editorial for the school magazine, isn't it?
- *Caller* : Yes. Just wanted to make sure you'll be there.
- *Sitara* : I will. Don't worry.
- *Caller* : **Bye, then.**
- *Sitara* : **Bye, Arun.**



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Useful points to remember

1. At the beginning of a telephone conversation:

- the person who answers the call says *Hello* and gives either the phone number or a name.
- the person who calls identifies herself / himself.

2. In the middle of the conversation:

- in formal conversations, the persons speaking on the telephone exchange information, keeping the dialogue brief and to the point.
- in informal conversations, they may talk to each other a little longer and also exchange news.



Useful points to remember

3. To end/close the conversation:

- they may say *Bye* or *Thank you/Thanks* or *That's all right/That's okay*, depending on the context.

4. Notice that the voice of the speakers moves from low to high:

- when they say *Hello*.
- when they make polite requests, as in *Could I talk to Mr Surendra, please?*
- Hold the line, please.
- when they ask questions politely, as in
- May I know who's calling?
- Would you like to speak to her?



Useful points to remember

5. You have learned to use shortened forms such as *I'll*, *I'm*, *we're*, *don't* and *can't* while speaking. But remember that at the end of a sentence: you cannot use shortened forms like *I'll*, *he's* and *we're*. For example:

- A: Raju, will you come to the temple tomorrow?
- B: Sure, *I will*. (not *I'll*)
- you can, however, use negative shortened forms such as *can't*, *don't* and *won't*. For example:
 - A: Rashmi, could you help me with my homework, please.
 - B: I'm sorry, Asif, *I can't*. I have a test tomorrow.

6. While talking on the telephone, people sometimes use:

- verbless sentences, for e.g. *Nothing much, Great, Good for you.* incomplete sentences, for e.g. *Just wanted to make sure* (instead of *I just wanted to make sure*) and *Let's* (instead of *Let's meet this evening.*)



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Dealing with a Wrong Number

- When you answer the telephone, you sometimes find that the caller has got a wrong number.
- The caller has either got connected to your number by mistake or has got the telephone number wrong, which means that the person he/she wants is not available on your number.
- This lesson will help you learn what to say in such a situation.
- Note that in this situation there is really no difference in the language you will use for calls made in formal and informal contexts.

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Dealing with a Wrong Number

- DIALOGUE 1
- *(The phone rings in Kartik's home.)*
- *Kartik:* **Hello.**
- *Caller :* **Hello, can I speak to Dr Narasimha, please?**
- *Kartik :* **Which number did you dial? (or Which number d'you want?)**
- *Caller:* 52419673
- *Kartik:* **I'm afraid you've got the wrong number. This is 52419672.**
- *Caller:* **Oh, I'm sorry.**
- *Kartik:* **That's okay.**

Taking and Leaving Messages

- Sometimes, when we answer a phone call or make one, the person who is needed is either not available or is busy and cannot take the time.
- In such a situation, the caller can leave a message.
- This lesson will help you learn how to take and leave telephone messages in formal as well as informal contexts.



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Taking and Leaving Messages

- DIALOGUE 1 (FORMAL)
- (*The phone rings in the Medak Girls Government Junior College.*)
- Secretary : **Good morning.** Girls Government Junior College, Medak
- Caller : **Good morning. Could I speak to Professor Raman, please**
- Secretary : Professor Raman is on leave. **May I know who's calling?**
- Caller : **I'm Jabbar Ali, from Mehbubia College. Could I leave a message, please**
- Secretary: **Just a minute, sir. (pause) Yes?**

Taking and Leaving Messages

- *Caller* : **Please tell him** that the meeting to be held on 15th April has been postponed to 4th May.
- *Secretary*: **D'you mind repeating that, sir?**
- *Caller* : The meeting scheduled for 15th April has been postponed to 4th May.
- *Secretary* : **Anything else, sir?**
- *Caller* : **You can ask him to call me** if he needs any more information. **My number is 28453536.**
- *Secretary*: 28453536. **I certainly will,** Dr Ali.
- *Caller*: **Thank you.**
- *Secretary*: **You're welcome, sir.**



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Taking and Leaving Messages

- DIALOGUE 2 (INFORMAL)
- *(The phone rings in Bharat's home.)*
- *Bharat* : **Hello.**
- *Caller* : **Hello. I'm Rani. Is Rekha there?**
- *Bharat* : **Hi, Rani. I'm Bharat, Rekha's brother. She's gone to the music class. I'll tell her you called.**
- *Caller* : **Thanks, Bharat. Please tell her I'll talk to her in the evening.**
- *Bharat* : **Okay.**
- *Caller* : **Thanks. Bye.**
- *Bharat* : **Bye.**

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Useful points to remember

During informal phone calls:

1. We do not usually use fixed expressions of politeness, such as

- *Can I speak to Rekha, please.*
- *May I know who's calling / speaking?*
- *Would you like to leave a message?*
- *Would you like me to take a message?*
- *Could I leave a message, please.*



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Useful points to remember

2. We often use the name of the person we are talking to, to sound friendly:

- *Hi, Rani.*
- *Thanks, Bharat.*



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